MIL-A-46771B(AT)
29 September 1982
SUPERSEDING
MIL-A-46771A(AT)
7 April 1969

MILITARY SPECIFICATION

AUTOMOBILE, HEARSE: COMMERCIAL

This specification is approved for use by the US Army Tank-Automotive Command, Department of the Army, and is available for use by all Departments and Agencies of the Department of Defense.

1. SCOPE

* 1.1 Scope. This specification covers a commercial hearse, utilizing a commercial limousine chassis and commercial cowl, with a hearse body conforming generally to the automobile manufacturer's style. Vehicles procured under this specification are commercial items which shall be warranted by the manufacturer as specified in procurement documents.

2. APPLICABLE DOCUMENTS

* 2.1 Government documents.

* 2.1.1 Specifications, standards, and handbooks. Unless otherwise specified, the following specifications, standards, and handbooks of the issue listed in that issue of the Department of Defense Index of Specifications and Standards (DoDISS) specified in the solicitation form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein.

Beneficial comments (recommendations, additions, deletions) and any pertinent data which may be of use in improving this document should be addressed to: US Army Tank-Automotive Command, ATTN: DRSTA-GBS.1, Warren, MI 48090, by using the self-addressed Standardization Document Improvement Proposal (DD Form 1426) appearing at the end of this document or by letter.

FSC-2310

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* SPECIFICATIONS

FEDERAL

W-B-131 - Battery, Storage: Vehicular, Ignition, Lighting and Starting.

MILITARY

MIL-B-46176 - Brake Fluid, Silicone, Automotive All Weather, Operational and Preservative.

* STANDARDS

MILITARY

MIL-STD-1223 - Non-Tactical Wheeled Vehicles Treatment, Painting, Rustproofing, Identification Marking, and Data Plate Standards.

* 2.1.2 Other Government documents, drawings, and publications. The following other Government documents, drawings, and publications form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein.

DEPARTMENT OF TRANSPORTATION (DoT)

Federal Motor Carrier Safety Regulations (FMCSR).

Federal Motor Vehicle Safety Standards (FMVSS).

(Application for copies should be addressed to the Department of Transportation, Federal Highway Administration, Washington, D.C. 20591.)

ENVIRONMENTAL PROTECTION AGENCY (EPA)

Control of Air Pollution from New Motor Vehicles and New Motor Vehicle Engines.

(Application for copies should reference the Code of Federal Regulations, 40 CFR, and the Federal Register and should be addressed to the Superintendent of Documents, U.S. Government Printing Office, Washington, D.C. 20402.)

* 2.2 Other publications. The following document(s) form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein. The issues of the documents which are indicated as DoD adopted shall be the issue listed in the current DoDISS and the supplement thereto, if applicable.

SAE, INC.

SAE Standards and Recommended Practices

J551 - Limits and Methods of Measurement of Radio Interference Characteristics of Vehicles and Devices (20-1000 MHz) (DoD adopted).

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J552 - External Electromagnetic Radiation Suppressors.

(Application for copies should be addressed to SAE, Inc., 400 Commonwealth Drive, Warrendale, PA 15096.)

THE TIRE AND RIM ASSOCIATION, INC.
Yearbook.

(Application for copies should be addressed to The Tire and Rim Association, Inc., 3200 W. Market Street, Akron, OH 44313.)

(Industry association specifications and standards are generally available for reference from libraries. They are also distributed among technical groups and using Federal agencies.)

* 2.3 Order of precedence. In the event of a conflict between the text of this specification and the references cited herein, the text of this specification shall take precedence.

3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 Standard vehicle and accessories. Except as specified in 3.1.1 through 3.1.1.4, the vehicles, components, assemblies, and accessories to be delivered under the contract shall be standard or optional items, which meet or exceed the requirements of this specification. All chassis items shall be as represented in the chassis, body, and equipment manufacturer's technical data. Technical data shall be limited to specifications and technical material identical to that furnished to the authorized company representatives for selection of vehicle models and components, and shall be on file in the engineering offices of the procuring activity, prior to delivery of the items.

3.1.1 Special requirements. In addition to the standard vehicle and components specified in 3.1, the vehicle shall be furnished with special equipment as specified herein.

3.1.1.1 Painting and marking. As specified by the procuring activity for the appropriate service (see 6.2), treatment, painting, identification marking, and data plates shall be in accordance with MIL-STD-1223.

* 3.1.1.2 Rustproofing. When specified (see 6.2), the vehicle shall be rustproofed in accordance with MIL-STD-1223.

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* 3.1.1.3 Cooling system. A heavy duty cooling system shall be furnished. The coolant shall be maintained at a temperature below the boiling point when the vehicle is operated at an altitude of 10,000 feet above sea level or in ambient air temperatures of not less than 125 degrees Fahrenheit (°F).

* 3.1.1.4 Silicone brake fluid. When silicone brake fluid conforming to MIL-B-46176 is the manufacturer's standard or optional brake fluid, it shall be provided in the hydraulic brake system. A tag shall be placed near the master cylinder stating "CAUTION: USE SILICONE BRAKE FLUID ONLY, MIL-B-46176."

3.2 General design.

* 3.2.1 Federal Motor Vehicle Safety Standards. The vehicle and furnished accessories shall comply with all Federal Motor Vehicle Safety Standards in effect on the date of manufacture.

* 3.2.2 Air pollution control. The vehicle shall comply with EPA Regulations governing Control of Air Pollution from New Motor Vehicles and New Motor Vehicle Engines in effect on the date of manufacture. In addition, vehicles destined for California shall comply with State of California regulations governing air pollution control in effect on the date of manufacture.

* 3.2.3 Curb weight. The vehicle, fully equipped with a full complement of fuel, lubricants, and coolant, shall have a curb weight of not less than 5,000 pounds. This weight shall include all accessories required by this specification.

* 3.2.4 Gross vehicle weight. The gross vehicle weight (GVW) shall be the vehicle curb weight, plus a driver and assistant driver computed at 175 pounds each, and a payload representing a casket and cadaver to weigh not less than 600 pounds. The load, distributed as specified, shall provide a GVW of not less than 5,950 pounds.

* 3.2.5 Wheelbase. The wheelbase shall be not less than 144 inches. Chassis frame rails shall not be spliced or otherwise extended to provide the specified wheelbase.

* 3.3 Performance. The vehicle shall be capable of transporting the rated payload (see 3.2.2) at a speed of not less than 55 miles per hour (mph).

3.3.1 Service brakes. The service brakes shall control and hold the vehicle, when loaded to its specified GVW, on a 30 percent grade. Under specified conditions of loading (see 3.2.4), the service brakes shall stop the vehicle from a speed of 20 mph in not more than 30 feet from the point at which movement of the brake pedal begins.

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Deceleration and stopping distance shall be demonstrated on a dry, hard, approximately level road surface that is free from loose material.

3.4 Chassis components.

* 3.4.1 Engine. The vehicle shall be equipped with a liquid cooled, internal combustion, four-stroke cycle gasoline engine with not less than eight cylinders. The engine furnished shall produce the required vehicle performance when operated on unleaded fuel with a research octane rating of 91, at engine speed not more than the manufacturer's recommended operating speed. The engine shall be capable of continuous, warranted operation on unleaded fuel. Unless otherwise specified or required by foreign laws, vehicles for overseas use shall be capable of accepting and operating on leaded gasoline.

3.4.1.1 Oil filter. A full flow type oil filter shall be furnished.

* 3.4.2 Ignition system. The ignition system shall be of 12-volt potential with an 80-ampere minimum alternator which provides not less than 16 amperes direct current (dc) output at normal engine idle speed.

3.4.4 Transmission. Manufacturer's standard automatic transmission shall be furnished.

* 3.4.5 Exhaust system. The exhaust system shall conform to Federal Motor Carrier Safety Regulation 393.83(a). The exhaust system shall be of corrosion resistant, leakproof construction. Extension of the exhaust or tailpipe shall not result in a reduced cross sectional area. Installation shall be such that exhaust fumes will not enter the body interior. The exhaust system shall be suspended using not less than 3 hangers.

3.4.6 Drive train. The drive train shall be adequate to transmit the net torque of the engine, as developed through the maximum gear train reduction.

* 3.4.7 Suspension. A heavy duty suspension system shall be provided and shall be equipped with hydraulic, double-acting, shock absorbers on front and rear axles. The suspension system shall have a rated capacity at least equal to the load imposed on each member, measured at the ground, with the vehicle loaded to the rated GVW, as specified in 3.2.4.

* 3.4.8 Wheels and tires. Steel belted radial or, when specified (see 6.2), bias ply tires shall be furnished. Tires shall be of the tube or tubeless type with highway tread. Tires shall be of a rated

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capacity at least equal to the load imposed on each tire, measured at each wheel, at the ground, with the vehicle loaded to the specified GVW. Rims and tire ratings shall conform to the Tire and Rim Association recommendations for the type and size of tires furnished.

3.4.8.1 Spare tire assembly. A spare wheel and tire assembly shall be furnished, mounted, and concealed within the vehicle body. The location of the spare tire assembly shall neither interfere with the function of the vehicle, nor necessitate moving the casket when removal of the spare is required.

* 3.4.9 Brakes. The vehicle shall be equipped with vacuum assisted hydraulic service brakes with front disc brakes.

3.4.10 Steering. Manufacturer's standard power steering shall be furnished.

3.4.11 Bumpers. Front and rear bumpers shall be provided.

* 3.4.12 Battery. The battery furnished shall be the manufacturer's recommended standard for the vehicle furnished. The battery shall be of the maintenance free type having the maintenance free characteristics listed in W-B-131.

3.4.13 Radio interference suppression. The vehicle shall be suppressed to limit electromagnetic radiation in accordance with SAE J551. Suppressors, where used, shall conform to SAE J552. Any body equipment emitting electromagnetic radiation shall be suppressed to the same level as the vehicle chassis.

3.5 Body. The body shall be integral with the cab and shall be essentially of steel construction. Hardware and other exposed metal trim shall be chrome plated, stainless steel, or anodized aluminum.

* 3.5.1 Construction and material. The body shall have roof and rear covered with sheet metal panels or fiberglass with metal roof bows and with provisions for doors and windows specified herein. Structural framing of the body shall support the exterior body surfaces without evidence of distortion under operating conditions. Sound-deadening material shall be applied on sides, roof, door panel interiors, and on framing to prevent drumming of panels and to inhibit rusting. Interior lining and trim material shall be treated to withstand exposure without spotting, shrinking, or warping.

3.5.1.1 Insulation. The body insulation shall be non-hygroscopic, non-combustible, fibrous material and shall be resistant to fungus growth. Insulation shall be anchored to prevent sag or insulation voids.

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* 3.5.1.2 Glass. All window glass shall be safety plate or safety sheet. The windshield shall be safety plate glass.

* 3.5.2 Driver's compartment. The driver's compartment shall be standard automobile type and shall include at least the following equipment:

(a) Inside rearview mirror
(b) Outside rearview mirror on each side; driver's side mirror adjustable by remote control
(c) Key-operated ignition switch
(d) Ammeter, voltmeter, or charging indicator
(e) Fuel gage
(f) Oil pressure gage or indicator
(g) Engine temperature gage or indicator
(h) Speedometer with recording odometer
(i) Ash receptacle
(j) Dual, padded sunvisors
(k) Arm rest, mounted on inside of each front door.

3.5.2.1 Seats. The driver's and assistant's seat shall be an upholstered, vinyl covered, full-width, adjustable seat and back assembly. Seat belts and seat belt retractors shall be installed for the driver and assistant.

3.5.2.2 Floor. Carpeting shall be fitted and attached to the floor in the driver's compartment.

* 3.5.2.3 Doors. Doors shall be furnished on each side of the driver's compartment. Seals shall be installed around doors to eliminate entry of water into the compartment. Doors shall be equipped with key-operated locks. A crank regulating mechanism shall be provided for each door window. When specified (see 6.2), doors shall be equipped with electric (key-operated) locks and electric window regulators.

* 3.5.3 Casket compartment. The casket compartment shall be of a size and arrangement adequate for the transportation, loading, and unloading through the rear door, of a casket case having a maximum gross weight, including weight of deceased, of 600 pounds. The compartment length (from partition to the rear of the body at the floor) shall be not less than 106 inches; the height (at center line of the floor, midway of the roof section) shall be not less than 36 inches; and the minimum distance between wheel housings shall be 46 inches. The interior color scheme shall be current available materials with all accessories and decor in matching or compatible colors.

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* 3.5.3.1 Floor. The floor in the casket compartment shall be not less than 5/8 inch marine plywood over the supporting underbody structure. The floor covering material shall be cemented to the wood flooring, or to the area of metal over the axle. The floor shall be covered with a decorative phenolic not less than .05 inch thick; or current production carpet material. Exposed edges of phenolic or carpet flooring material shall be covered with rustproof, corrosion resistant metal or moldings.

3.5.3.2 Side doors. One side door with a stationary window shall be provided on each side of the casket compartment. When specified (see 6.2), electric (key-operated) locks shall be furnished.

3.5.3.3 Rear door. A rear door with inner and outer panels shall permit unhampered loading of the casket. The rear door shall be arranged to open and close from the inside and outside. Locks shall use the same key as the driver's door. The window shall be of glass permanently set in the door.

3.6 Accessories and equipment.

3.6.1 Casket rack. A casket rack and rollers for rear loading shall be provided. Locking devices shall be furnished for properly positioning and holding of the casket case or casket in fully extended position at the rear for loading or off-loading and in retracted position while being transported. The casket rack shall be chrome plated or stainless steel.

* 3.6.2 Draperies. Draperies shall be installed on all windows in the casket compartment. Materials shall conform to the decor specified for the interior (see 3.5.3) and shall be treated to prevent spotting, shrinking, or fading due to exposure to the elements or from contact with floral arrangements.

3.6.3 Windshield wipers and washers. The vehicle shall be equipped with electric operated, dual windshield wipers and windshield washers. Windshield wiper motors shall have not less than two operating speeds.

* 3.6.4 Tools. Each vehicle shall be furnished with tools required for exchanging a mounted tire assembly with the spare assembly and shall include at least a jack, jack handle, and wheel nut wrench. The jack shall be of such closed height as to permit its location under the axle or other satisfactory lift point at any wheel with the tire flat. The jack shall be capable of raising the loaded vehicle to a height adequate to permit removal and replacement of the wheel and tire assembly.

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3.7 Heating and cooling. The heating and cooling systems shall provide controlled heating, cooling, and fresh air flow, as desired.

3.7.1 Heating system.

3.7.1.1 Driver's compartment heating. The heater shall be of the engine coolant type and shall include a heavy duty windshield defroster to maintain a clear windshield under high humidity conditions and in temperatures down to minus 10°F. The heater shall have a means for controlling the air flow to the heater or defroster ducts.

3.7.2 Ventilating system. Ventilators shall be provided in the cowl section and in the doors of the driver's compartment.

3.7.3 Air conditioning. The manufacturer's standard air conditioning system shall be furnished.

3.7.3.1 Tinted windows. Tinted safety glass shall be furnished for all windows, including the windshield.

3.8 Lighting.

3.8.1 Exterior lights. The vehicle shall be equipped with manufacturer's standard headlights, parking lights, taillights, stop lights, back up lights, directional signal lights, and a four-way flasher. Headlights shall be furnished with a control for selecting a high or low beam. Directional signal lights may be combined with stop lights at the rear and with parking lights at the front. Taillights and stop lights may be incorporated into the same housing. The control for directional signals shall be the self-cancelling type, with visible and audible flash indicators, and shall be wired through the ignition circuit.

* 3.8.2 Interior lights. The vehicle shall be equipped with at least one driver's compartment light. Indirect lighting shall be furnished for the instrument panel. Two dome lights shall be installed in the casket compartment. Casket compartment lights shall operate when any casket compartment door is opened.

* 3.10 Servicing and adjusting. Prior to acceptance of the vehicle by the Government inspector, the contractor shall service and adjust each vehicle and its mounted equipment for operational use including at least the following: alinement of lights; adjustment of the engine and brake systems; filling and charging of battery; inflation of all tires; complete lubrication of chassis, engine, running gear, and mounted equipment with grades of lubricants recommended for the ambient air temperature at the delivery point; servicing of cooling system with a

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solution of ethylene glycol type antifreeze and water in equal parts by volume; and servicing of windshield washer reservoir with water and appropriate additives.

3.11 Workmanship. Defective components or parts and assemblies which have been repaired or modified to overcome deficiencies shall not be furnished. Welded, bolted, and riveted construction utilized shall be in accordance with the highest standards of the industry.

4. QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS

4.1 Responsibility for inspection. Unless otherwise specified in the contract, the contractor is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified in the contract, the contractor may use his own or any other facilities suitable for the performance of the inspection requirements specified herein, unless disapproved by the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in the specification where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

4.2 Government verification. Quality assurance operations performed by the contractor will be subject to Government verification at unscheduled intervals. Verification will consist of observation of the operations to determine that practices, methods, and procedures of the contractor's inspection are being properly applied. Failure of the contractor to promptly correct product deficiencies discovered shall be cause for suspension of acceptance until correction has been made or until conformance of product to specification criteria has been demonstrated.

4.3 First production vehicle inspection. The first production vehicle produced under the contract shall be inspected by the contractor at his plant under the direction and in the presence of Government representatives. The purpose of the inspection shall be to determine vehicle conformance to the contract. Acceptance of the first production vehicle shall not constitute a waiver by the Government of its rights under the provisions of the contract.

* 4.3.1 Vehicle weight. The first production vehicle shall be weighed to determine curb weight and the distribution of curb weight on the front and rear axles. The imposed loading on front and rear axles will be computed using the curb weight, the operator and assistant operator weights at 175 pounds each, and the payload (see 3.2.4), to provide the specified GVW. The calculated imposed loads on front and rear axles will be utilized to ascertain that the suspension, axles, and tires furnished are of adequate capacity to meet contractual requirements.

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* 4.3.2 Road test. The first production vehicle will be examined and road tested (with payload) by the contractor to assure that the vehicle will operate in accordance with contractual requirements.

* 4.3.3 Radio frequency suppression verification. The vehicle manufacturer shall furnish, with the questionnaire (commercial vehicle engineering data), a description of all interference suppression devices used to suppress vehicle electromagnetic radiation in accordance with SAE J551. Data shall be sufficient for visual determination that all required suppression devices are installed on the vehicle.

* 4.3.4 Production sample. Upon acceptance of the first production vehicle, it shall remain at the manufacturing facility as a production sample, and shall be the last vehicle shipped on the contract. The contractor shall maintain the vehicle in a serviceable condition for the duration of the contract.

* 4.3.5 Failure. Failure of the first production vehicle to meet requirements of the contract shall be cause for the Government to refuse acceptance of all vehicles under contract until corrective action has been taken.

* 4.4 Inspection of production vehicles. The contractor's inspection system shall, as a minimum, assure that the vehicle conforms to the physical and dimensional requirements and is capable of meeting performance requirements contained herein. For each vehicle under contract, the contractor shall make available to the Government, at the point of final acceptance, records acceptable to the Government indicating that the servicing and adjusting required by 3.10 have been accomplished.

* 5. PACKAGING

5.1 Vehicle processing. The vehicle shall be processed for shipment, from manufacturer's plant to initial receiving activity, in accordance with the manufacturer's standard commercial practice.

6. NOTES

6.1 Intended use. The vehicles covered by this specification are intended for use by the Armed Services in transporting caskets between military bases, posts, and other establishments, over improved roads and highways under all conditions of weather, equivalent to those which may be encountered on highways and access roads to bases and posts.

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6.2 Ordering data. Procurement documents should specify the following:

(a) Title, number, and date of this specification.
(b) Identification of appropriate service for painting and marking (see 3.1.1.1).
(c) Concealed marking, if required (see 3.1.1.1).
(d) Rustproofing, if required (see 3.1.1.2).
(e) Bias ply tires, if required (see 3.4.8).
* (f) Electric front door locks and window regulators, if required (see 3.5.2.3).
* (g) Electric side door locks, if required (see 3.5.3.2).

6.3 Identification of changes. The margins of this specification are marked with asterisks to indicate where changes (additions, modifications, corrections, deletions) from the previous issue were made. This was done as a convenience only and the Government assumes no liability whatsoever for any inaccuracies in these notations. Bidders and contractors are cautioned to evaluate the requirements of this document based on the entire content irrespective of the marginal notations and relationship to the last previous issue.

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Army - AT
Project No. 2310-A407

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